Project Management

Homework 1:

Pick any product of your choice and analyze the product life cycles (from development to production) considering its features and value.

Digital product: Hair Bundle Guide

Value: A digital guide that helps customers choose the right hair before purchasing

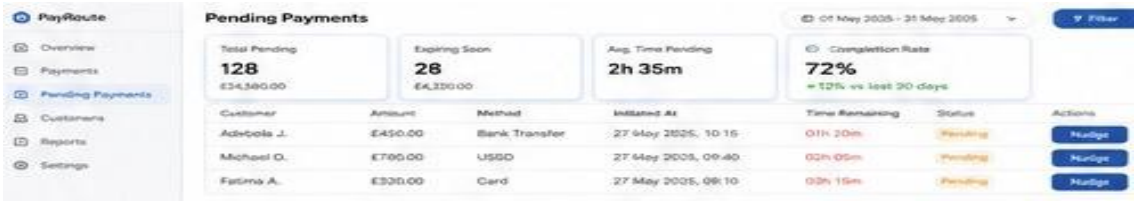
STAGE	WHAT OCCURS	FEATURES	VALUE MADE
IDEATION	A potential problem - customer doesn't know about the lengths of the bundles and how much they need or if they want frontal or closure.	Hair lengths, textures, bundle quantities	User experience becomes easier and reduces enquiries from customers.
CONCEPT	The potential solutions to the problem that can be turned to a product relying on the purpose.	Raw hair education, product comparison, FAQs, care guide.	Clear specification of how the product will be created.
DESIGN	Wireframes, initial draft layout with specified sections.	Length charts, texture info, images of hair.	Able to bring ideas to visuality to understand.
TESTING	Test by a small group, and get their feedback and see if they get the right concept and know how to navigate the guide easily.	Accuracy with the expected outcome for testing and readability.	Identify information that is confusing and any technical issues occurring.
PRE-LAUNCH	Promoting the upcoming product and release to pre market before the launch.	Social media previews and adverts.	Frequent promotion shows recognition towards customers.
LAUNCH	Release of the guide to the customers, showcased as free with an order or paid by digital product.	PDF, QR code or a link to get access to the guide.	Upsell the products in the business with clearer information.
POST LAUNCH	Monitoring feedback and sales with the analytics, Updating the guide with new suggestions.	Adding new products, updating product range/price when needed.	Shows consistency in accuracy and it will continue to be relevant.

Homework 2:

Scenerio

You are a Product Manager at PayRoute, a UK-based fintech that helps SMEs collect payments from customers via bank transfer, USSD, and card. Over the last quarter, the customer success team has flagged a recurring complaint: merchants lose sales because customers who initiate a transfer often don't complete it, and merchants have no visibility into "in-flight" transactions. The CEO has asked your squad to explore a "Pending Payments Dashboard" that lets merchants see initiated-but-not-completed transactions in real time, nudge customers to complete payment, and reconcile faster. The CEO wants two documents before any engineering work begins: a Business Requirements Document (BRD) to align leadership and stakeholders on the why, and a Product Requirements Document (PRD) to guide the design and engineering teams on the what and how. Include a short reflection at the end explaining the difference between your BRD and PRD and why certain information belonged in one and not the other.

BUSINESS REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT (BRD)	
Section	**Details**
Executive Summary	PayRoute will introduce a 'Pending Payment Dashboard' to give merchants visibility into initiated-but-not-completed transactions in real time, due to customers not completing their transfers. This will help merchants recover lost sales, reduce manual follow-ups, and reconcile faster.
Business Objectives	Aim is to reduce order cancellations due to incomplete payments by 15%. Increase successful payment completion by 20%. And to reduce time to reconcile transactions by 30%. This will improve the merchant's satisfaction by passing the target.
Scope	**In scope:** Real-time view of pending payments, Customer nudges using SMS/Whatsapp/Email and in-app notifications, Having a filter with search and sorting of which payments have been completed and not completed with the time/date of the event. Export pending payments. Having analytics and performance on display to understand movement. **Out of scope:** Automated refunds, Dispute management, multi currency support.
Stakeholders	**Executive:** CEO, **Product:** Product Manager, Product Designer **Engineering:** Backend, Frontend, QA Business: Finance advisors **Others:** Merchants, Customers
Functional Requirements	The system must display all uncompleted payments in real time, Must show payment method, time limit of the transaction, customer details, send payment reminders via SMS/Whatsapp,Emails and in-app notifications, Filtering with time/date and what payment has been completed and not completed, system must allow export of pending payments in CSV format, system should show status of payment automatically if its been completed or expired, so no lost of data has occurred.
Assumptions/ Constraints	Integration of the SMS/whatsapp etc is available, Timeline of completion should take up to 14 weeks, GDPR must be in place with operations, Budget of the project is £200,000, Payment process includes real-time data.
Success Metrics (KPIs)	Reduce order cancellations due to incomplete payments by 15%. Increase successful payment completion by 20%. Reduce time to reconcile transactions by 30%. Use of the dashboard by merchants should increase by 70% within the first 80 days.

PRODUCT REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT (PRD)	
Section	**Details**
Product Overview	**Purpose:** Allowing merchants to see pending payments that can be utilised using tools to nudge customers, creating more sales. **Vision:** Becoming a platform that helps customers who lost their transactions they couldn't complete, creating a seamless payment process. **Goals:** Improving payment completion and reducing follow ups manually.
User Personas	**Merchant Owner (Alexa)** 25, runs an online store, Needs to track payments and recover lost sales easily **Finance Manager (Keiran)** 30, manages finances for a banking chain, Needs accurate data for reconciliation and reporting
User Stories	As a **Merchant Owner,** I want to **see all pending payments in real time** so that **I can follow up and recover sales**. As a **Merchant Owner,** I want to **send reminders to customers** so that **they can complete their payments.** As a **Finance Manager,** I want to **filter and export pending payments** so that I **can reconcile faster.**
Feature Requirements	**Dashboard Overview:** Will show the total amount of pending payments, payments that are expiring soon, averaging time remaining on the payments. **Pending Payment List:** Showing the customer details, the amount on their transaction, method of payment they used, time/date it occurred, time remaining on that transaction, status of the transaction. **Nudge Customer:** Sending reminders through whatsapp, SMS, email and in-app notifications. **Payment Details View:** See full details of the transaction once you press and it will show on a side panel for multi-use. **Filters&Search:** Filter the transactions through date, payment method, amount or the status. **Real-time updates:** Automated updates when refreshed or when payment is completed or expired. **Exports Data:** Payments that are pending can be extracted by exported by CSV.
Non-Functional Requirements	**Performance:** Dashboard and its features will load within 3 seconds. **Availability:** 100% uptime (unless it's under renovation management). **Scalability:** Able to collect more merchants aiming up to 30,000+ within the 5 months. **Security:** Encrypting data at all positions rest and in transit also when exporting data must be protected. **Compliance:** GDPR.
Wireframes/Designs	
Acceptance Criteria	• Dashboard displays pending payments in real time • Merchants are able to send reminders successfully using the tools • Filters return the correct results • Exported CSV contains the correct data and is protected • Status updates automatically change when payment is completed or expired.

The BRD explains why PayRoute should build the Pending Payments Dashboard. It focuses on the business problem, objectives and the KPIs and what the scope should include. This helps leadership understand the project's value and what is expected from the product and its effect on the business positively. The PRD explains what should be built and how it should work for the individuals using it. It includes personas, user stories, features and what it would look like visually, so it could be worked towards it. Keeping them separate ensures that the business goals remain concise and clear while the product team has enough entail on what to build and the end goal of how it should be and to test the solution so it programs the correct results linking to the business aims effectively.

Homework 3:

Create a Product roadmap for a food delivery app

Product Area	August 1-15	August 16-31	September 1-15	September 16-30
Customer App	NOW User registration Customer profiles	NOW Restaurant browsing Menus & basket	NEXT Favourites Search filters	LATER Group orders Reorder feature
Payments	NOW Payment setup	NOW Card payments Order confirmation	NEXT Digital wallets	LATER Promo codes Loyalty planning
Delivery	NOW Rider registration Rider assignment	NOW Order status Estimated delivery	NEXT Live GPS tracking	LATER Delivery optimisation
Restaurant Tools	NOW Restaurant onboarding	NOW Receive & manage orders	NEXT Menu Management Promotions	LATER Advanced analytics
Rider Tools	NOW Rider onboarding	NOW Accept & update jobs	NEXT Navigation Earnings dashboards	LATER Performance analytics
Customer Support	NOW Basic support setup	NOW Issue reporting	NEXT Improved support tools	LATER AI-assisted support research
Legend NOW - Must-have		NEXT - Important improvements		LATER - Future features

The key principle behind this roadmap is to launch the realistic version of the product that successfully delivers the core food-ordering and delivery experience, then use future releases to improve, expand and scale the app.

Homework 4:

Assignment

You are the PM for PayBridge, a new digital wallet targeting small business owners in Nigeria who currently rely on cash and informal savings groups. PayBridge wants to help these merchants collect payments via QR code and USSD, and eventually save and access micro-loans.

You have just joined the team.

Leadership wants you to:

- **Set the product's goals for the next quarter**
- **Figure out what to actually build first**
- **Define who you're building for**

Section 1: OKRs & KPIs

Task 1: Draft one Objective with 3 Key Results for PayBridge's next quarter.

Objective

- At the end of next quarter, merchants will be able to collect payments via QR code consistently. And turning cash transactions to a secondary use. Allowing small business owners to be able to accessPayBridge too.

Key Result

- New registered merchants have completed more than 1 digital payment collection within 5 days of registering (Leading indicator)
- QR code is easily navigated and understood for new users, when calculating the increase of completed digital payments by 40% within 30 days, from past data. (Lagging indicator)
- Confirmation on emails, reporting that payment collection has been received on the merchant's side. Gives that reassurance and trust (Lagging indicator)

Task 2: Identify 4 supporting KPIs you'd track weekly to monitor progress toward these KRs

- The average time it takes from registration to first completed payment (shows if a merchant had a seamless process or difficulty occurred during onboarding or payment issues).
- Weekly activity on merchant's transactions (shows if the merchant business is growing or getting no customers or its stationary)
- How long it takes to get a confirmation - target is 50 seconds.

Task 3: Critique. Below is a real OKR draft written by a fictional colleague. Identify what's wrong with it

Objective: Improve the app

KR1: Ship QR payments, USSD payments, and savings feature

KR2: Get more users

KR3: Make customer support faster

What is Wrong?

- The objective is vague, doesn't state what improvements are being made and who the improvements are intended for, and the problem being solved.
- KR1 is listing out features, but not ensuring if these features are going to be adopted correctly by the customers and if it matches the problems and adaption needed.
- KR2 is not distinctive enough, as users can be anything. It doesn't state what type of users is the target and how many more users are the target in this specific timeframe.

Better Version:

Objective: At the end of next quarter, merchants will be able to collect payments via QR code consistently. And turning cash transactions to a secondary use. Allowing small business owners to be able to accessPayBridge too.

KR1: QR code is easily navigated and understood for new users, when calculating the increase of completed digital payments by 40% within 30 days, from past data

KR2: New registered merchants have completed more than 1 digital payment collection within 5 days of registering

KR3: Confirmation on emails, reporting that payment collection has been received on the merchant's side. Gives that reassurance and trust

Task 4: Stakeholder wants a KPI should be added: "Number of features shipped per sprint." Explain why this is a poor KPI, and suggest a better alternative.

The number of features shipped per sprint measures how much the team produces, not if PayBridge implementation benefits the merchants. For instance, a team can make many features that no customers would use, while another team can implement one feature that adds great value allowing more completed payments. Focusing on the customer behaviour and performance rather than the quantity. Quality over quantity.

Section 2: Product Discovery

Task 1: Before writing a single line of code, design a 2-week discovery sprint for PayBridge. Your plan must include:

Hypothesis:

"Small business owners who get introduced to digital payments would take it onboard because cash handling causes problems or is more hassle to handle that digital payments can solve"

This is falsifiable because merchants can state how cash handling works for them and working with digital payments can be more of a hassle for them.

Proceed → If a merchant is willing to see other options,research also shows problems of cash-handling. **Pivot** → The research doesn't fully align with the problems the merchants have. **Stop** → Merchant doesn't want to proceed and is adamant on cash handling being suitable for them.

"PayBridge provides a simple payment process that merchants can easily complete payment collection with no assistance"

This is falsifiable because assuming the merchants digital literacy or the smartphone they are using familiarity would affect the usability.

Proceed → A merchant that is approved for testing doesn't have any altercations or interference with the researcher helping. **Pivot** → A merchant that is approved for testing has some difficulty at certain steps but can be improved on simplifying or assisted onboarding be included. **Stop** → A merchant that is approved for testing is not able to complete a payment at all regardless with the minimal help required.

Discovery methods:

Taking customer interviews + observation → Observing how much money comes through the business, for instance, the day process of customers paying,how change is processed, where the cash is stored, how is each sale being recorded. This observation will allow us to determine digital literacy if it is capable of their standards and how to adhere to it. Instead of just asking their opinion of the app. Conducting interviews to different varieties of small market business owners instead of grouping them together will allow us to get different perspectives.

TWO WEEK SCHEDULE SPRINT

DAY	ACTIVITY
DAY 1	Align on assumptions, define target merchant criteria, establish hypotheses
DAY 2 - 4	Conduct contextual interviews and observe merchants handling payments and cash.
DAY 5	Synthesise findings, identify recurring problems and refine hypotheses.
DAY 6 - 7	Build a low-fidelity payment experience/prototype and prepare the concierge test.
DAY 8 - 10	Run controlled payment experiments with merchants and, where appropriate, their customers
DAY 11	Analyse behaviour, failure points, objections and trust concerns.
DAY 12	Test revised experience with a second small group.
DAY 13	Compare evidence against predefined proceed/pivot/stop criteria.
DAY 14	Present findings, validated assumptions, unresolved risks and recommended MVP scope.

Task 2: Write 5 customer discovery interview questions you'd ask a market trader who currently uses cash only.

1. When's the last time handling cash has caused problems for your business? → **Good** → real-time past data, discovering pain points that have occurred.
2. How are records kept of how much money you've made per day? → **Good** → Merchant can explain the process instead of assuming how they do so
3. The process of how your customer pays you? → **Good** → allows the merchant to explain how their business operates and the behaviours along with it when handling such.
4. Using QR codes for payments is better than cash, do you agree? → **Weak** → Forced, as they would not answer from their experience but a socially answered yes.
5. If using PayBridge and it has a seamless process, would you use it? → **Weak** → This is a hypothetical, as it's not based on any real opinion as it is a leading question.

Task 3: Explain the difference between problem discovery and solution discovery, using PayBridge as your example.

Problem Discovery: Is what problems exist and who are they related to and how can they be dealt with.

For PayBridge, merchants may find it difficult separating business income with personal income and dealing with change.

Solution Discovery: Is what is the best solution to a problem and if it brings value to the customers using it

For PayBridge, using QR payments, USSD payments will be beneficial towards the problems that need to be solved.

Section 3: User Personas

Task 1: Build one primary persona for PayBridge based on the scenario.



Kareebah would trust PayBridge if:

- Payment confirmation is immediate and easy to understand.
- The process is simple enough to use without extensive technical knowledge.
- Fees are clearly explained before she starts using it.
- She can reliably access her money.
- Failed or disputed transactions have a clear resolution process.
- She can get human assistance when something goes wrong.
- Other trusted traders demonstrate that the service works reliably.

What could make her refuse to adopt it:

- Payments frequently fail.
- She cannot tell whether a payment has actually arrived.
- Fees are confusing or unexpectedly high.
- Accessing her money is difficult.
- The onboarding process is complicated.
- She believes digital payments expose her to loss.
- The service does not solve a problem important enough to justify changing from cash.

Task 2: Build a secondary persona who's not well served by the primary persona but who still interacts with the product

Rebbeca — 68 – Elderly Customer Paying Kareebah → **Role:** Older customer who occasionally purchases goods from Kareebah.

Rebbeca is involved because PayBridge's merchant experience depends also on the customer's ability and willingness to make a completed payment. She may have less familiarity with smartphone interfaces due to her age and could struggle with QR scanning or navigating a digital payment process. Even though she is not the primary persona, repeatedly excluding customers like Rebecca could result in less customers in that age range and not adopting the use of the payment product not being suitable for all. Therefore requires understanding the customer's side of the payment interaction as well.

Task 3: A colleague says: "We already know our users — we're all Nigerian, we all understand market traders, we don't need personas." Respond to this as a PM would, referencing at least one concrete risk of skipping this step.

I would state that the team has valuable first-hand knowledge of Nigerian consumers, but being Nigerian does not mean everyone has the same needs, behaviours, financial movements or level of digital awareness.

The biggest risk of skipping personas is allowing the team to design for an imaginary "average Nigerian trader." For example, one team member might assume that a trader has a smartphone, understands QR codes, is comfortable with digital financial services and has reliable connectivity, while another trader may have very different circumstances. For PayBridge, that could lead directly to a product decision such as making QR the centre of the experience when some target merchants or their customers struggle to use it. A persona is therefore not about stereotyping users; it is a practical tool for making explicit who we are prioritising, what context they operate in, and whose needs we are deliberately not optimising for first. As PayBridge conducts discovery and gathers behavioural data, the persona should be updated when the evidence shows that the team's assumptions were wrong.

Homework 5:

Assignment

PayBridge has completed discovery. Findings confirmed: market traders want to accept digital payments but distrust apps they don't understand, are price-sensitive, and are heavily influenced by what other traders in their market/cluster are already using. The product team has built an MVP: QR code payment collection + USSD fallback for feature phones, with instant settlement notifications. Leadership now wants a GTM strategy to launch in one Lagos market, state your assumption before wider rollout. You are the PM. Sales, marketing, and ops are waiting on your GTM plan to start executing.

Assumption: I would launch first in Balogun Market, because it has a lot of traders, strong peer influence community, and consistent customer transactions—making it suitable for a cluster-based launch.

Positioning & Messaging

1. Write a positioning statement for PayBridge using this structure:

For **market traders** who **want to accept digital payments without difficult apps or high prices**, PayBridge is a **simple digital payment collection service** that **lets customers pay by QR code or USSD with instant notifications.** Unlike **cash, or unfamiliar payment strategies**, PayBridge gives traders **a simple payment option they can use directly while seeing immediate confirmation of payments**.

1b. Identify the primary alternative(s) traders currently use. For each alternative, state PayBridge's specific advantage and disadvantage against it.

Alternative	PayBridge advantage	PayBridge disadvantage
Cash	Faster reconciliation, less need to handle/store cash, instant payment notification	Cash is universally understood and requires no setup or connectivity
POS agents	Trader can receive payments directly rather than relying on an agent	POS agents may already be trusted and familiar to traders
Existing payment apps	QR + USSD provides a simpler option, particularly for customers with feature phones	Existing apps may have greater brand recognition and broader functionality

2. Write 3 messages for 3 different audiences who all touch this GTM: (a) the trader themselves, (b) a market association leader/influencer within the cluster, (c) an internal PayBridge sales agent doing door-to-door signups.

Trader:

> "Your customer can pay you by simply scanning your PayBridge QR or using USSD, and you get an immediate notification. No difficult app to learn—just collect your money and keep selling."

Market association leader:

> "PayBridge can help traders in the market accept digital payments without forcing them to learn an advanced system. We want to work with the association first, prove it works with a small group of traders, and then expand across the cluster."

Sales agent:

> "Don't start by selling the technology—start by showing the trader how they receive money. Demonstrate QR, demonstrate USSD, make one test transaction, and ask the trader to recommend it to other shops once they understand it."

Channel & Launch Strategy

1.Recommend a launch motion. Choose and justify one primary go-to-market motion as primary, and explain why the others are secondary or wrong for this specific market and user base. Justify against the discovery findings above

Primary motion: Field sales + association-led cluster launch. This should be the primary motion because the three discovery findings directly point towards human-led adoption within a concentrated cluster:

- Trust deficit: Face-to-face demonstrations reduce fear of an unfamiliar product.
- Price sensitivity: Sales agents can clearly explain the launch pricing and value.
- Peer influence: Getting respected traders and association leaders onboard creates visible proof.

The association should open the door, while field agents conduct the actual onboarding and demonstrations.

Secondary motion:

- Digital acquisition: Useful for awareness and retargeting but unlikely to overcome the initial trust barrier on its own.

- POS partnerships: Potentially useful later, but POS agents could view PayBridge as competing with their existing role.

2.Design the first-30-days launch plan for the single chosen market. Include: Pre-launch activities (what has to be true/ready before day 1), Launch week activities, What "traction" looks like by day 30, One key risk that could derail this launch and your mitigation for it.

Pre-launch

Before Day 1:

- Secure association leadership approval.
- Recruit 9 field sales agents.
- Identify 6 - 9 influential traders willing to become early adopters.
- Ensure QR codes are generated and working.
- Test USSD properly.
- Confirm notification reliability.
- Prepare simple Yoruba/English sales materials/languages
- Establish customer support processes.
- Finalise launch pricing and incentives.

Launch week

Days 1–2: Association briefing and onboarding of influential traders.

Days 3–5: Door-to-door demonstrations and signups around the initial cluster.

Days 6–7: Follow up with new users, resolve payment issues and collect trader feedback.

Day-30 traction target

Assumption: 9 agents × 5 successful onboardings × 20 working days = 900 onboarded traders.

Target by Day 30:

- 900 registered traders
- 600 activated traders who complete at least one real transaction
- 400 weekly active traders
- At least 100 customer referrals
- Payment success rate of 95%
- At least 2 association actively recommending PayBridge

Key Risk: Traders sign up but do not actually use PayBridge.

Mitigation: Measure real transactions rather than registrations, conduct same-week follow-ups, identify inactive traders, and use successful early adopters to demonstrate PayBridge to other traders.

3.Decide whether PayBridge should charge transaction fees from day one, subsidize/waive fees during launch, or use another pricing approach for this initial market. Justify your choice against the risk of (a) traders not adopting due to cost sensitivity and (b) the business needing to prove monetization eventually. State the trade-off explicitly.

I would integrate PayBridge transaction fees for the first 30 days, rather than permanently offering free transactions. This directly addresses the discovery finding that traders are price-sensitive and reduces the perceived risk of trying an unfamiliar product. However, the free period should be explicitly positioned as a launch incentive, with traders informed before the end of the period what the normal pricing will be. Trade-off: Free transactions should increase trial and adoption, but PayBridge temporarily sacrifices transaction revenue and risks attracting users who only participate because the service is free. Therefore, the experiment should measure repeat usage and willingness to continue after the incentive, not just registrations.

Metrics & Cross-functional Alignment

1. Define your GTM success metrics for the first 90 days. Give: North Star-type metric for this launch, supporting metrics with target numbers, metric you will explicitly NOT optimize for in this phase, and why.

Monthly Active Transacting Traders: 2,000 traders by Day 90 → A trader counts only if they complete at least one genuine customer payment during the month. This prevents registrations from being mistaken for product adoption.

Assuming:

- **70% activation rate**
- **60% retention rate**

The acquisition target needs to be approximately: 2,000 ÷ 70% ÷ 60% = 4,762 registered traders

	Metric	Day-90 target
Acquisition	Registered traders	4,800
Activation	Registered traders completing ≥1 transaction	3,360 (70%)
Retention	Activated traders still transacting 30 days later	2,016 (60%)

Assumption: The launch starts with one market cluster and scales gradually rather than attempting nationwide acquisition immediately.

Metric we will NOT optimize for: Total app downloads/registrations.

A large registration number would look impressive but would not prove that traders trust PayBridge or that customers are actually using it. The priority is real payment activity and repeat usage.

2. Write a one-page GTM brief you'd hand to Sales, Marketing, and Ops leads to kick off execution. It must be scannable in under 2 minutes and answer: what are we launching, to whom, how, and how will we know it's working. This is a communication artifact, not a repeat of your answers above.

Launch Objective: Establish PayBridge as a trusted, simple way for Balogun Market traders to accept digital payments, then use proven adoption to support expansion into other Lagos markets.

WHAT ARE WE LAUNCHING?

PayBridge:

- QR-code payment collection
- USSD fallback for feature phones
- Instant notifications
- 30-day transaction-fee trial during launch

WHO ARE WE TARGETING?

Primary: Market traders in Balogun Market.

Initial focus: Traders and influential/connected traders who can demonstrate PayBridge to neighbouring businesses.

HOW ARE WE LAUNCHING?

Primary motion: Field sales + market association

1. Secure association.
2. Recruit and train 9 field agents.
3. Onboard influential traders first.
4. Demonstrate QR + USSD in person.

5. Complete a test transaction during onboarding.
6. Follow up with inactive traders.
7. Use successful traders as peer advocates.

Supporting channels: WhatsApp/community communication and targeted digital awareness. Digital advertising is supporting activity, not the primary acquisition engine.

PRICING

0% PayBridge transaction fee for the first 30 days. Purpose: Remove the financial barrier to trying an unfamiliar product while generating enough real transactions to test product-market fit. Monetisation pricing is introduced after the launch experiment.

WHAT DOES SUCCESS LOOK LIKE?

Day 30

- 900 registered traders
- 600 activated traders
- 400 weekly active traders
- 95% payment success rate

Day 90

- 4,800 registered traders
- 3,360 activated traders
- 2,016 monthly active transacting traders
- 60% 30-day retention

Monthly Active Transacting Traders.

We care about traders actually receiving payments—not simply downloading, registering, or attending a demonstration.

TEAM OWNERSHIP

Sales: Trader acquisition, demonstrations, onboarding and follow-up.

Marketing: Trader education, testimonials and peer advocacy.

Ops/Product: QR/USSD reliability, notifications, support and issue resolution.

LAUNCH PRINCIPLE

Trust first → trial second → repeat usage third → monetisation and expansion.

Critique

1. A fictional colleague proposes this GTM plan for PayBridge's Lagos market launch: "We'll run Instagram and Facebook ads targeting 'small business owners in Lagos,' offer a 3-month free trial, and aim to onboard 50,000 users in the first month across Nigeria." Identify at least 4 distinct problems with this plan, referencing the discovery findings and target market from the scenario. Then rewrite it as a 3–4 sentence corrected version.

Problems

1. **Wrong primary channel:** Instagram/Facebook advertising does not directly solve the trust problem for traders who distrust unfamiliar apps.
2. **Ignores peer influence:** The plan does not use market associations, influential traders or cluster effects.
3. **Poor geographic focus:** Jumping to 50,000 users across Nigeria before proving adoption in one market
4. **Free trial:** Three months is unnecessarily long and delays learning whether traders will pay; it also increases the risk of free users who never become paying customers.
5. **Wrong success measure:** 50,000 “users” could mean registrations rather than traders actually receiving payments.

Corrected version:

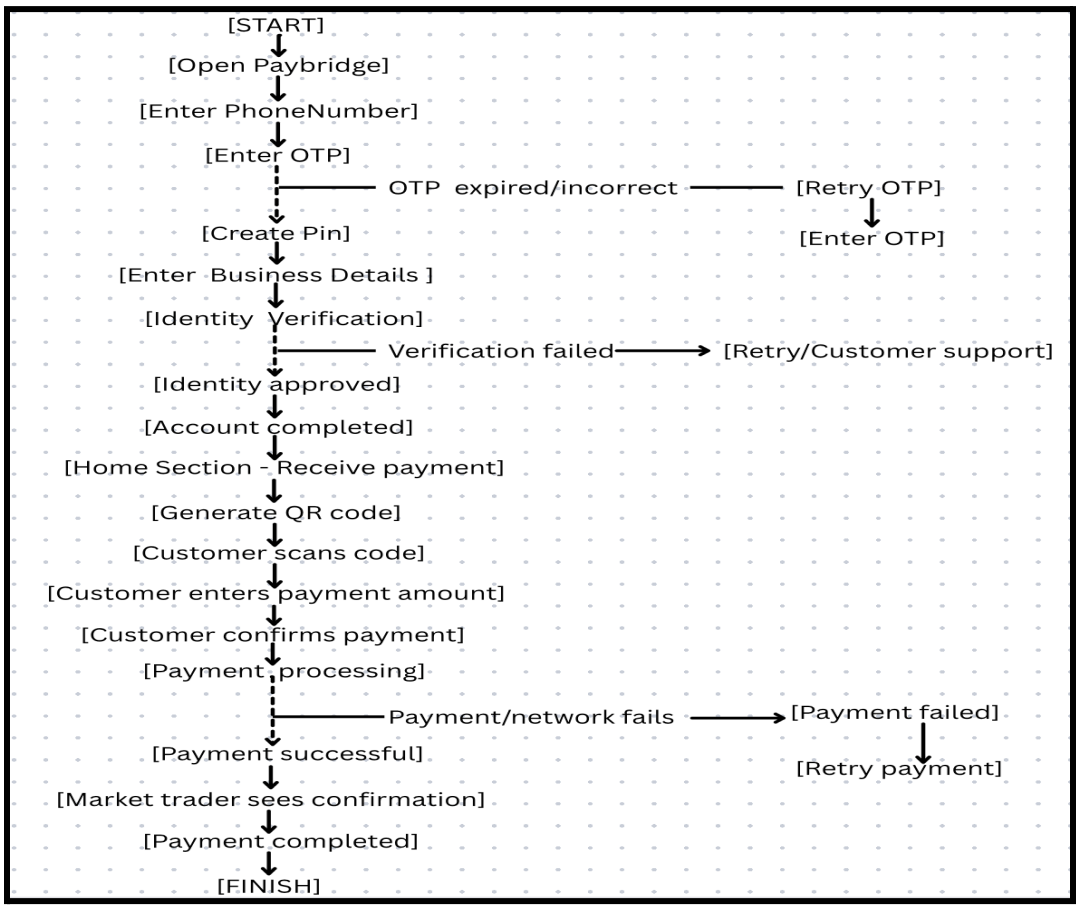
PayBridge should first launch in Balogun Market, Lagos, using market association relationships and field agents to build trust through face-to-face communications. We should onboard influential traders first, then use their adoption and referrals to spread PayBridge through the cluster. A 30-day transaction-fee waiver should reduce the cost barrier while we measure real payment activity and repeat usage. If we achieve strong activation and retention, we can use the evidence from Balogun Market to guide expansion into other Lagos markets before considering a wider Nigerian rollout.

Homework 6:

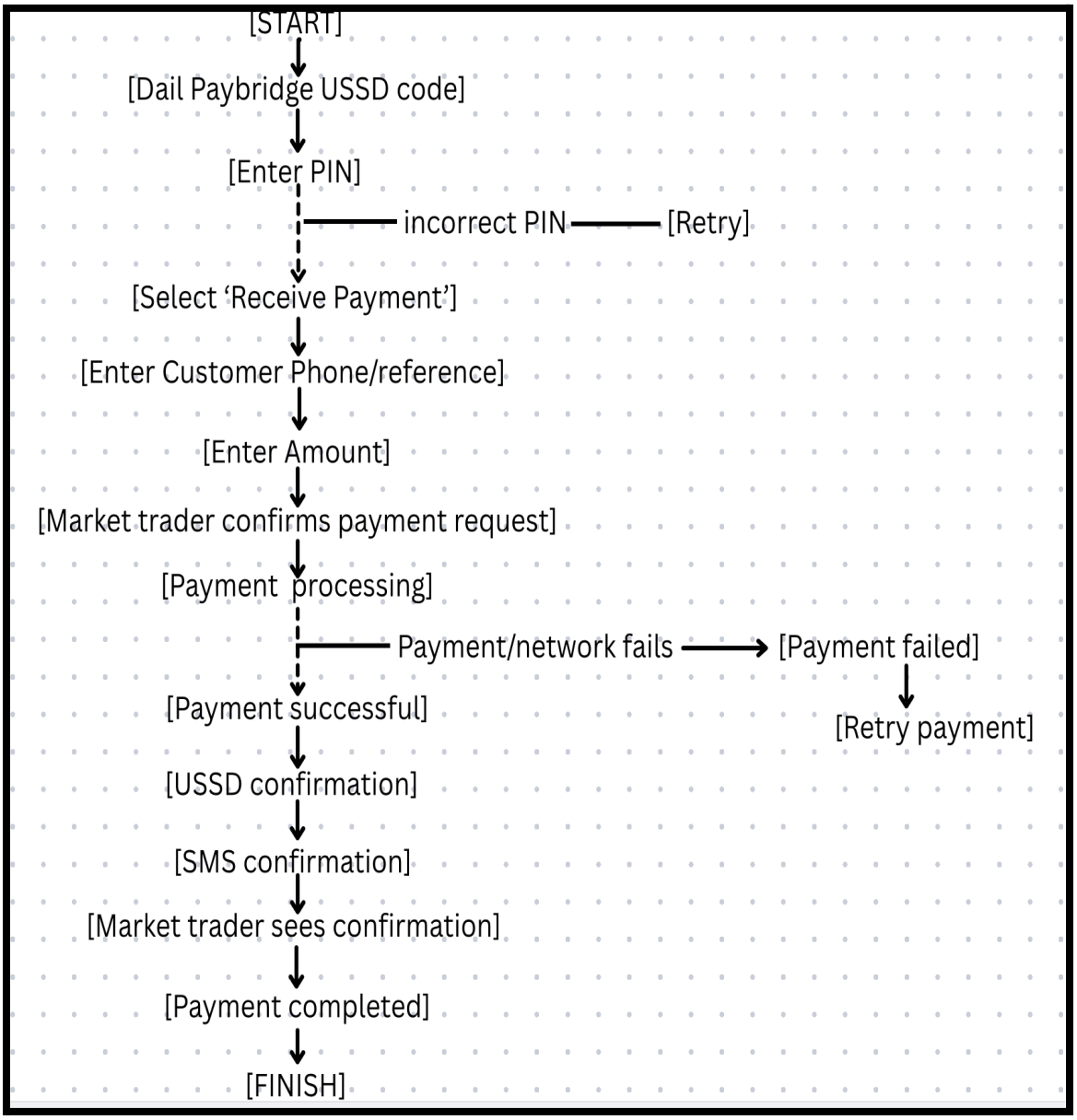
PayBridge is now moving from discovery into design. Leadership has asked you to scope and rough out one core flow: a market trader receiving their first payment via PayBridge, from opening the app to seeing money settled. Reminder of context from discovery: many traders have low digital literacy, some use feature phones (USSD), trust is low, and they are highly influenced by what other traders around them are already doing.

User Flow Diagram

1. Map the primary flow. Create a user flow diagram for: "Trader signs up, sets up their account, and receives their first payment via QR code."



2. Map a second flow for the USSD/feature-phone path for the same core job (receiving a payment), showing how it differs from the smartphone flow.

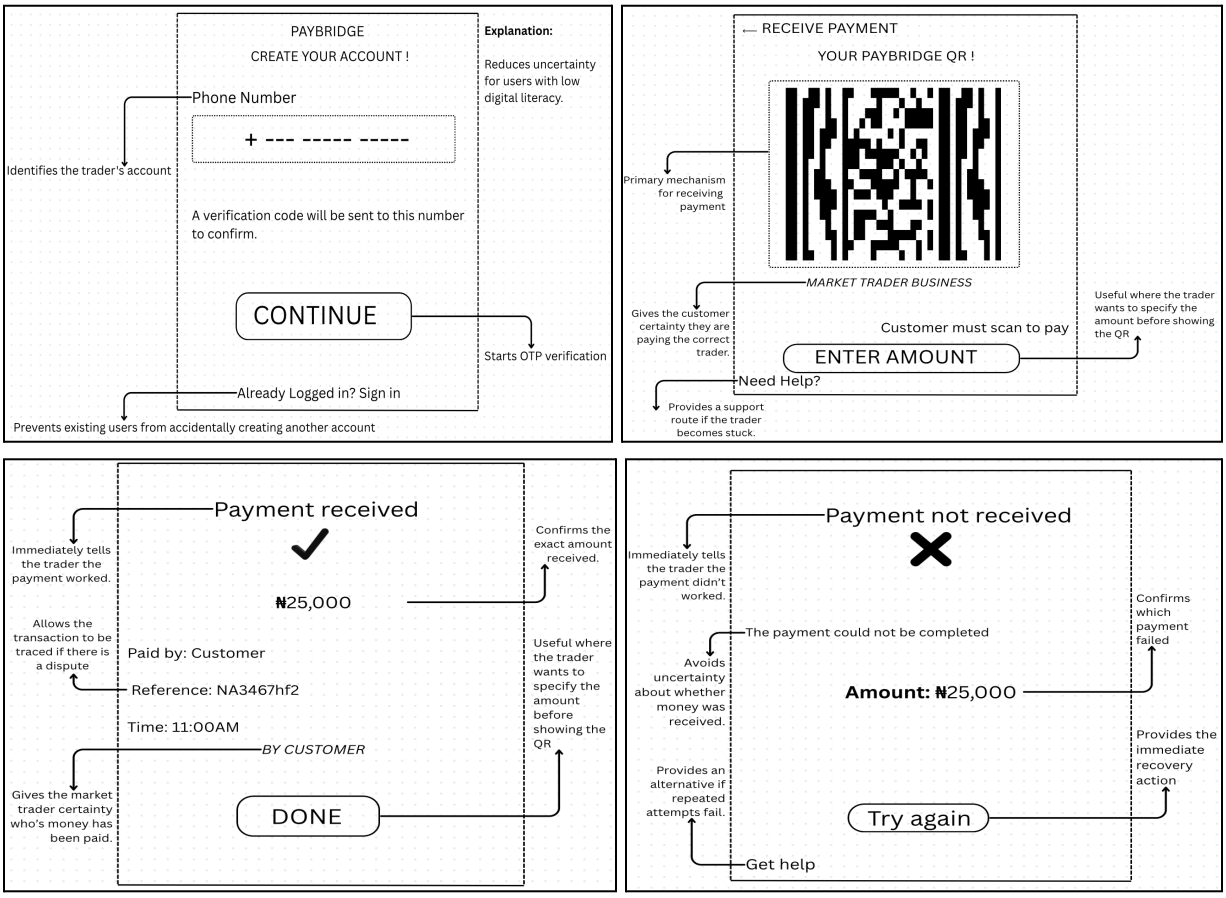


3. Identify one point in your primary flow where a trader is most likely to drop off or get confused, based on the discovery findings (low trust, low digital literacy). Explain what you'd change about the flow — not the UI, the flow — to reduce that drop-off.

One point is in the primary flow is the identity verification, as a low digital literacy trader probably wouldn't understand why their ID would be needed by someone they don't know, and what they will use it for. This is important because discovery found that trust is low from the market trader. To change the flow of the path. We would Explain why verification is needed → Start the verification → Verification put in plan → Verification completed → Account is now completed.

Wireframes

1. Wireframe 4 key screens from your primary flow (low-fidelity is fine — boxes, labels, and annotations; Each wireframe must be annotated: label what each element is, why it's there, and what happens when the user interacts with it.



2. For the QR/payment-received screen specifically: explain what information must be visible immediately (no scrolling, no tapping to reveal) for a first-time, low-trust user to feel confident the payment actually went through. Justify each element you chose to prioritize.

INFORMATION	JUSTIFY
Payment status	The trader needs to know immediately whether it succeeded.
Amount received	Confirms the customer paid the expected amount.
Trader/business name	Confirms the transaction belongs to the correct account.
Customer identifier	Helps the trader recognise the transaction.
Transaction reference	Provides evidence if there is a dispute.
Time of payment	Helps match the payment to the transaction.

Scope & Trade-off Judgment

1. Engineering tells you the USSD flow will take 3x longer to build than the smartphone-only flow, and leadership wants to launch in 6 weeks. You can only ship one for the initial pilot market. Using what you know about the target users from discovery, decide: ship smartphone-only first, or USSD-only first, or a reduced version of both? Justify your decision and state what you're consciously giving up with your choice.

Decision: Ship a reduced version of both → The discovery make smartphone-only heighten because:

- Some traders use feature phones.
- Digital literacy is low.
- Excluding feature-phone users could exclude part of the target audience.

Reduced MVP:

Smartphone	USSD
Account creation	PIN
Essential KYC	Receive payment
PIN	Confirm amount
Receive payment	Payment status
QR generation	SMS confirmation
Payment confirmation	
Basic transaction status	

What we're consciously giving up:

We would not build a full feature with both smartphones and USSD. USSD would have fewer features and a simpler payment flow. We would also not include non-functional requirements such as advanced transaction history, analytics, tutorials and richer account management.

2. A designer hands you a beautifully designed onboarding flow with 9 screens before the trader can receive their first payment (terms acceptance, phone verification, business details, ID upload, selfie verification, PIN setup, tutorial carousel, notification permissions, and a final "you're all set" screen). Identify which of these you'd push back on cutting or combining, and why, given this specific user base.

Screen	Decision	Justify
Terms acceptance	**Keep, cutting**	May be legally required, but should not become a long standalone journey.
Phone verification	**Keep**	Needed to establish and secure the account.

Business details	**Keep, cutting**	Collect only information required for compliance.
ID upload	**Keep**	Potentially mandatory for compliance.
Selfie verification	**Cut**	Adds extra security and longevity.
PIN setup	**Keep**	Important for account security.
Tutorial carousel	**Cut**	Adds friction before the user reaches the core value.
Notification permissions	**Combine**	Do not interrupt onboarding unless notifications are essential to receiving payments.
"You're all set" screen	**Combine**	The trader should move directly into the product and receive payment.

Homework 7:

Create a Product Teardown Analysis for Chowdeck

1. Target User

- Working professionals who want food delivered quickly without visiting a restaurant.
- Users ordering for themselves, friends, family.
- Also serves users looking for groceries, local markets and other everyday services without leaving their premises.

Key need: Convenience, speed and reliable delivery.

2. Core Value Proposition

Chowdeck makes it easy to find restaurants in a nearby area, order and receive food at your location without having to travel.

The main value is: *"I want what I crave, and I want it delivered to me."* Chowdeck has quick onboarding, food choices, live order updates and 24/7 customer support.

3. User Journey — From Download to Delivery

Download & Open: The user downloads Chowdeck from the App Store or Google Play and opens the app.

Goal: Get the user to order. UX strength: The app's gain is immediately centred around delivery and convenience.

Sign Up: The user creates an account by providing:

- First name
- Last name
- Phone number
- Email

They then verify their account using an OTP sent by SMS/email.

Delivery Address: The user provides their delivery location so Chowdeck can show close restaurants

Why it matters: Restaurant availability, delivery distance and delivery fees depend on location. Chowdeck states that delivery fees are based on the distance between the restaurant and delivery address. UX strength: Shows what is actually available nearby.

Homepage: The user arrives at the main homepage. They can explore different services, including:

- Restaurants

- Shops/groceries
- Pharmacies
- Local markets
- Events
- Bills

UX strength: Multiple services make Chowdeck more reliable. UX friction: More categories can potentially make the experience feel less focused for someone who simply wants food.

Discover a Restaurant: The user browses restaurants available in their area. They can look through different food options and select a restaurant.Restaurant availability can change depending on opening hours and whether the restaurant is currently accepting orders.

Browse Menu: The user enters the restaurant and:

- Views the menu
- Selects food
- Chooses quantities/options
- Adds items to their basket

Core UX goal → Make choosing food as straightforward as possible.

Cart & Checkout: The user reviews their order before paying. The checkout shows the price breakdown, including the delivery fee. Chowdeck shows the delivery fee before the user confirms the order. Potential friction: Additional fees can cause users to abandon their basket if the final price is substantially higher than expected.

*Place Orde*r: The user confirms payment and places the order. Chowdeck then sends the order to the restaurant for acceptance and preparation. User expectation: "I've paid — now I want reassurance that my food is actually coming."

Order Tracking: The order progresses through stages such as: Order Received → Preparing → Ready → Rider Accepted → Rider at Restaurant → In Transit → Arrived → Delivered. Chowdeck also introduced live rider tracking so users can see the rider's location in real time. UX strength: Visibility reduces uncertainty after payment.

Delivery: The rider collects the order and delivers it to the customer's location. The user receives the order and the journey is completed. Success metric: Food arrives quickly, accurately and in good condition.

UX Strengths

What Chowdeck does well

1. Simple core value → The purpose is easy to understand: get food and other essentials delivered.
2. Localised discovery → Users see restaurants relevant to their delivery location.
3. Clear order process → The timeline gives users visibility throughout the delivery.
4. Real-time tracking → Users can see where their rider is during delivery.

UX Friction

Where could the experience be improved?

1. Sign-up friction → Having to enter several details and verify OTPs adds friction before the first order.
2. Choice overload → A large number of restaurants, products and services can make decision-making harder.
3. Price sensitivity → Delivery/service fees can increase the final checkout price.
4. Restaurant availability → A restaurant may appear unavailable because it has paused orders or reached capacity, which can frustrate users.
5. Delivery uncertainty → Even with tracking, delays between restaurant preparation and rider pickup can create frustration.

Business Model

Chowdeck generates revenue through the deliveries

Potential revenue sources include:

- Delivery fees
- Service fees
- Restaurant commissions

Chowdeck explicitly states that delivery fees contribute towards rider compensation, fuel and logistics infrastructure.

Improvement Opportunities

Faster first-order onboarding → Allow users to get from download → browsing → ordering with as little friction as possible.

Personalisation → Recommend restaurants based on:

- Previous orders
- Favourite cuisines
- Location
- Budget

Stronger loyalty system → Reward frequent users with:

- Discounts
- Free delivery
- Loyalty points

Improve delivery transparency → Give users increasingly accurate ETAs throughout the journey and clearly explain delays when they happen.

Encourage repeat ordering → Features such as "Order again", favourites and saved meals could reduce the time required to place another order.

Homework 8:

INCLASS WORK:

You want to build a food delivery app. Write 4 features you would include in the MVP and 2 features you would leave for a later version. And justify.

4 CORE FEATURES

1. Have the partnered restaurants displayed and accessible to order from - users are able to see what is available to order.
2. Check out to pay - Needed to complete their order and for it to be processed towards the restaurant.
3. Restaurant management - They are able to receive the orders that have been made and to accept or decline and to keep track of them.
4. Update of order - Users can see the status of the order. If its been in confirmed or not, in preparation, looking for driver, out for delivery etc

2 LATER FEATURES

1. AI chat bot - Gives recommendations on what the user may want from previous searches or user giving ideas of what they are interested in and AI points to the best restaurant suited for them
2. Discount - For users who frequently use the delivery app will get a discount or a specific restaurant they get points etc.